News Release
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S&P Global Flash France PMI®

French private sector slips back into contraction in October

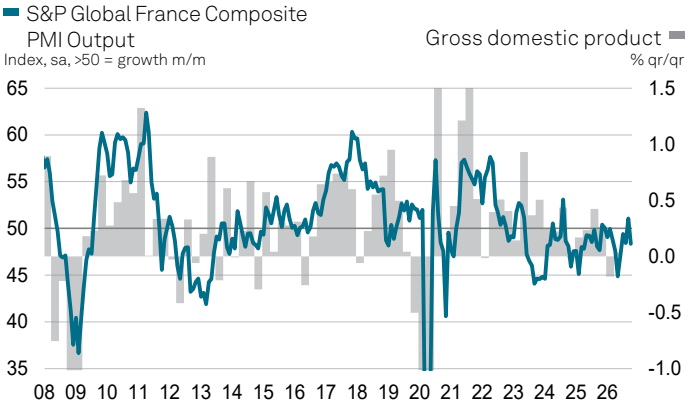
October 2026

Flash France PMI Composite Output Index: 48.4 (Sep: 51.1). 4-month low.

Flash France Services PMI Business Activity Index: 48.4 (Sep: 51.2). 2-month low.

Flash France Manufacturing Output Index: 48.5 (Sep: 50.3). 3-month low.

Flash France Manufacturing PMI: 49.3 (Sep: 50.6). 11-month low.



Data were collected 12-21 October 2026.
Sources: S&P Global PMI, INSEE via S&P Global Market Intelligence. © 2026 S&P Global

France's private sector economy deteriorated in October, according to the latest S&P Global flash PMI® data, marking a quick reversal from September's growth rebound. Weighing on activity levels was the sharpest decline in demand for French goods and services since May, which surveyed businesses attributed to heightened uncertainty and economic pressures. Regarding business expectations, the latest data showed the most pessimistic assessment of the French economic outlook in six-and-a-half years.

Meanwhile, the survey's price gauges decreased from September to signal an easing of input cost and output charge inflation rates. This was entirely services-led, sector data revealed, as a worsening of supply-chain conditions drove manufacturing price pressures higher.

The headline S&P Global Flash France Composite Output Index – which is based on approximately 80-90% of total survey responses and intended to give an early indication of the final figures – fell back beneath the 50.0 no-change threshold in October, dropping to 48.4, from 51.1 in September. Subsequently, the measure signalled a renewed decrease in private sector business activity.

Businesses that reported lower output highlighted uncertainty linked to both the domestic and international environment as a factor. Challenging economic conditions more broadly were also cited as a reason for reduced investment and spending activity.

Indeed, October survey data signalled the sharpest drop in new private sector sales since May. Manufacturers and service providers reported steeper declines in demand amid reports of projects being postponed as customers held back on decision making. New business from abroad remained a drag on total order books, with private sector export volumes

Comment

Joe Hayes, Senior Principal Economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

"September's rebound in economic activity proved to be short lived, which is hardly surprising given the rapid tightening of financial conditions and a further increase in political pressures across France during October. Today's PMI data showed that this immediately manifested itself through reduced purchasing and investment activity as private sector sales volumes fell at the quickest pace since May.

"October figures could be a prelude of what's to come as the survey's sentiment indicator, which explicitly asks firms about their expectations for the next 12 months, sank to a six-and-a-half-year low. This reflects firms' concerns about what is shaping up to be a highly uncertain 2027 Presidential Election, compounding pre-existing worries about France's fiscal situation.

"A slight positive from the latest flash survey was on prices, which showed inflation rates easing thanks to a softening on the services side. This suggests, at least in France, that energy price spillover effects are contained for now."

PMI® by S&P Global

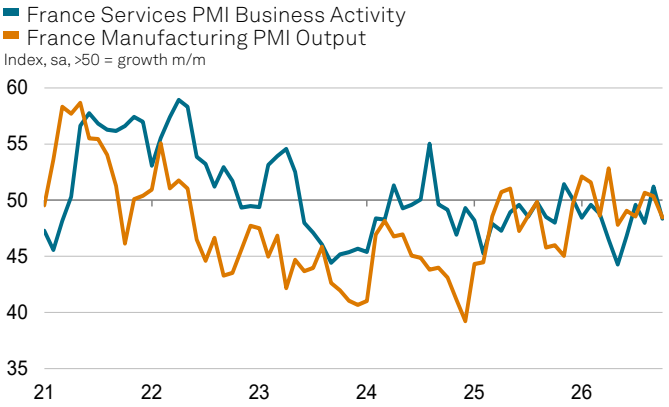
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shrinking for an eleventh successive month.

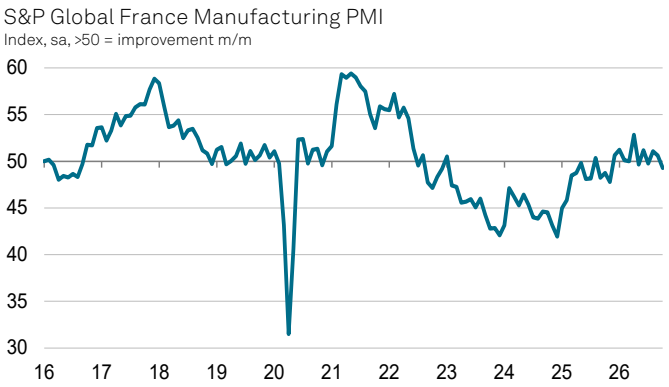
Against a backdrop of contractions in business activity and incoming new order levels, French businesses turned pessimistic towards the 12-month outlook in October. In fact, the Composite Future Output Index sank to its lowest level since April 2020 and indicated negative corporate sentiment for the first time in close to two years. Downbeat expectations were often linked to next year's election period, with some companies also expressing concerns regarding public finances.

As for private sector payroll numbers, the flash PMI survey pointed to yet another reduction across France, extending the current period of decline to six months. Job shedding was seen across both monitored sectors, although the methods through which employment was lowered varied. Lower headcounts were often attained by not replacing leavers or not renewing fixed-term contracts, but there were also mentions of restructuring. Reduced workforce numbers did not hinder firms' ability to clear outstanding business. Backlogs of work fell in a broad-based fashion during October, albeit marginally overall.

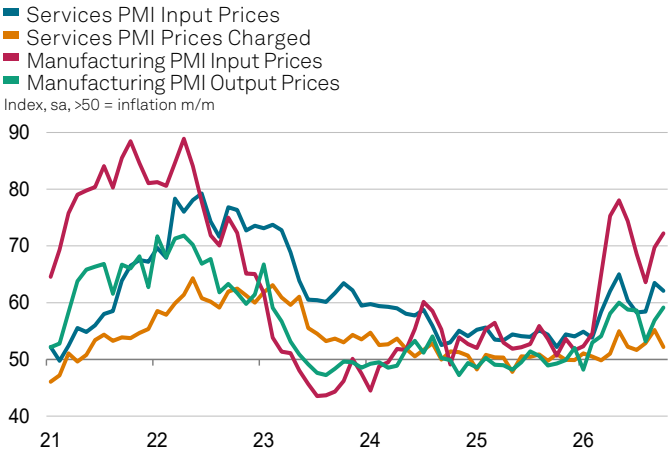
On prices, data at the composite level signalled an easing of inflation across France in October. The service sector was the main driver, with slower rates of input cost and output charge inflation offsetting sharper price pressures for manufacturers. Goods producers raised their prices charged to the greatest margin since May amid worsening supply-chain conditions. Delivery delays were the most pronounced since June as transportation issues and shortages lengthened lead times.



Source: S&P Global PMI. ©2026 S&P Global.



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Methodology

Final October data are published on 2 November for manufacturing and 4 November for services and composite indicators.

The S&P Global Flash France Composite PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to survey panels of around 400 manufacturers and 400 service providers. The panels are each stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. The services sector is defined as consumer (excluding retail), transport, information, communication, finance, insurance, real estate and business services.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. The following variables are monitored:

Manufacturing: Output, new orders, new export orders, backlogs of work, stocks of finished goods, employment, quantity of purchases, suppliers' delivery times, stocks of purchases, input prices, output prices, future output.

Services: Business activity, new business, new export business, outstanding business, employment, input prices, prices charged, future activity.

A diffusion index is calculated for each manufacturing and services variable. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

Composite indices for are calculated by weighting together comparable manufacturing and services indices using official manufacturing and services annual value added.

The headline figure is the Composite Output Index. This is a weighted average of the Manufacturing Output Index and the Services Business Activity Index. It may be referred to as the 'Composite PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI, which is a weighted average of five manufacturing indices (including the Manufacturing Output Index).

The headline manufacturing figure is the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

The headline services figure is the Services Business Activity Index. This is a diffusion index calculated from a single question that asks for changes in the volume of business activity compared with one month previously. The Business Activity Index is comparable to the Manufacturing Output Index. It may be referred to as the 'Services PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI.

Flash data are calculated from around 80-90% of total responses and are intended to provide an accurate early indication of the final data. Since flash data were first processed, the average differences between final and flash index values for the headline indices are:

Composite Output Index = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.4)

Services Business Activity Index = -0.1 (absolute difference 0.5)

Manufacturing PMI = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.3)

S&P Global do not revise underlying survey data after first publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series. Historical data relating to the underlying (unadjusted) numbers, first published seasonally adjusted series and subsequently revised data are available to subscribers from S&P Global.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

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